

Word family: **occupy / occupies / occupied / occupying / occupation / occupancy / occupant / occupier / occupational**

Base word: occupy

Forms: occupies, occupied, occupying

Related forms: occupation, occupancy, occupant, occupier, occupational

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / related nouns and adjective (相關名詞及形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “...whether private educational activities should be allowed to **occupy commercial dining space** for hours at a time.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **occupy** means **to take up and use a particular physical space, preventing or limiting other people from using that space at the same time**.

繁體中文：***佔用；佔據；使用某個空間，使其他人不能同時使用**

中文翻譯：

> “...allowed to **occupy commercial dining space** for hours at a time.”

「.....是否應該被允許一連數小時**佔用商業用餐空間**。」

Here:

occupy dining space = 長時間使用 / 佔着餐廳的座位、桌子或空間

1. **occupy = take up physical space (空間) — 佔用；佔據**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: To fill, use, or take up a particular amount of physical space.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Tutorial groups can **occupy** several tables for hours.”

「補習小組可能會一連數小時**佔用**幾張桌子。」

Practice 2

> “The sofa **occupies** most of the room.”

「這張梳化**佔據**了房間大部分空間。」

Practice 3

> “Each machine **occupies** about two square metres.”

「每部機器大約**佔用**兩平方米的空間。」

occupy = 某人 / 某物實際使用、填滿或佔去某個位置或空間

Common:

- * occupy a seat
- * occupy a table
- * occupy space
- * occupy a room
- * occupy most of the area

2. **occupy** = use/live in a building, room, seat, etc. (使用 / 居住) — 使用 ; 居住於 ; 佔用

Occupy can mean actually being in and using a place.

Practice 4

> “The family **occupies** the top floor.”

「這個家庭**住在 / 使用**頂層。」

Practice 5

> “The office is currently **occupied** by another company.”

「這間辦公室目前由另一家公司**使用 / 佔用**。」

occupy premises/room/building = 實際居住或使用某處地方

This is closely related to Meaning 1, but here the emphasis is on **possession/use of premises**, not simply how much space something physically takes up.

3. **occupied** = already in use (位置) — 有人使用的 ; 已被佔用的

This is an extremely common adjective-like use.

Practice 6

> “I’m sorry, this seat is **occupied**.”

「不好意思，這個座位**有人 / 已被佔用**。」

Practice 7

> “All the tables were **occupied**.”

「所有桌子都**有人使用 / 坐滿了**。」

****occupied = 某個位置、房間、座位等目前已有人使用****

This belongs to the physical-use branch.

4. ****occupied = toilet/bathroom currently in use (洗手間) — 使用中 ; 有人****

A highly conventional practical use:

> ****Occupied****

on a toilet/bathroom indicator means:

****有人使用中****

Opposite:

> ****Vacant****

= 無人 / 空置

This is not a separate semantic core, but it is useful enough to surface explicitly.

5. ****occupy = hold a position, office, rank, or role (職位) — 擔任 ; 佔有某職位****

****Occupy**** can mean holding a particular position in an organization or hierarchy.

Practice 8

> “She **occupies** a senior position in the company.”

「她在公司**擔任**高級職位。」

Practice 9

> “He **occupied** the post for five years.”

「他**擔任**這個職位五年。」

occupy a position/post/office = 擔任、處於某個正式職位或位置

This is a major abstract extension of physical location:

> a person metaphorically “fills” a position.

6. **occupy** = take a particular place in an order/ranking (位置 / 排名) — 處於 ; 佔據

Things can **occupy** a position in:

- * a ranking
- * a list
- * a hierarchy
- * a scale
- * a diagram

Practice 10

> “The company **occupies** third place in the market.”

「這家公司在市場上**位居**第三。」

Practice 11

> “The topic **occupies** a central position in the debate.”

「這個議題在辯論中**佔據**核心位置。」

occupy a position = 在某個順序、結構或抽象空間中處於某個位置

For core counting, this can remain with Meaning 5.

7. **occupy = fill someone's time / keep someone busy (時間) — 佔用時間；使忙於**

Occupy can mean keeping someone busy or filling their available time.

Practice 12

> “The task **occupied** most of my afternoon.”

「這項工作**佔用了**我下午大部分時間。」

Practice 13

> “The children were happily **occupied** with a puzzle.”

「孩子們正專心拼拼圖，**忙得不亦樂乎**。」

occupy someone / occupy someone's time = 使某人有些事情做，或佔去某人的時間

This is a major figurative sense.

8. **occupy oneself with something = keep oneself busy (固定結構) — 忙於；從事**

Practice 14

> “She **occupied herself with** reading while she waited.”

「等待期間，她以閱讀讓自己**有事可做 / 忙起來**。」

Practice 15

> “He **occupied himself with** small repairs.”

「他一直**忙着**做一些小修理。」

occupy oneself with something = 讓自己投入某項活動，以填滿時間或保持忙碌

This belongs to Meaning 7 rather than requiring another core meaning.

9. **occupy = hold someone's attention or thoughts (思想) — 佔據心思；吸引注意**

Occupy can mean filling someone's mind or attention.

Practice 16

> “The problem **occupied** her thoughts all day.”

「這個問題整天都**佔據**着她的思緒。」

Practice 17

> “The question continued to **occupy** his mind.”

「這個問題一直**縈繞 / 佔據**着他的腦海。」

occupy someone's mind/attention/thoughts = 令某件事持續成為某人的思考或注意焦點

This is distinct enough from physical space to display separately.

10. **occupied** = busy / engaged (人物) — 忙着的 ; 正忙於某事的

Practice 18

> “She is **occupied** with another task at the moment.”

「她目前正**忙着處理**另一項工作。」

Practice 19

> “Keep the children **occupied** during the journey.”

「旅途中要找點事情讓孩子們**有事做 / 不會無聊**。」

Here:

occupied = 正在做某事 , 因此沒有空閒

This is the adjective-like result of Meaning 7.

11. **occupy** = seize and control territory/buildings by force (軍事 / 政治) — 佔領

This is one of the most important distinct senses.

Meaning: To enter and control a country, territory, city, building, etc., especially using military

force.

Practice 20

> “The army **occupied** the city.”

「軍隊**佔領**了這座城市。」

Practice 21

> “The territory remained **occupied** for several years.”

「該地區被**佔領**了數年。」

occupy territory = 進入某地並實際控制該地，通常帶有軍事或強制性

This is not simply “take up space”; the key concept is **control**.

12. **occupy** = take possession of a building/place as protest (抗議) — 佔據；佔領

Groups of protesters can **occupy** a building, road, university, public square, etc. as a form of protest.

Practice 22

> “Protesters **occupied** the building overnight.”

「示威者通宵**佔據**了該建築物。」

Practice 23

> “Students **occupied** the hall in protest.”

「學生以抗議方式**佔據**了大堂。」

occupy = 以集體進駐並拒絕離開的方式控制某個地方，通常作為抗議手段

This shares the **take/control a place** concept with Meaning 11 but does not necessarily involve military force.

For strict counting, I would place it under the same control-possession branch.

13. **occupy = possess or use land/property legally (法律 / 物業) — 佔用 ; 實際使用**

In property and legal contexts, **occupy** may mean physically possessing or using premises.

Practice 24

> “The tenant has the right to **occupy** the property.”

「租客有權**佔用 / 居住於**該物業。」

Practice 25

> “The premises are **occupied** for commercial purposes.”

「該處所現作商業用途**使用**。」

This is an established legal/property use of Meaning 2.

Related form: **occupancy**

Occupancy has several important branches.

**occupancy = state of being occupied/used (入住 / 使用) **

Practice 26

> “The building is ready for **occupancy**.”

「這棟建築已可供**入住 / 使用**。」

**occupancy = proportion of rooms/seats being used (入住率 / 使用率) **

Practice 27

> “The hotel has an occupancy rate of 90%.”

「這間酒店的**入住率**為百分之九十。」

Common:

* hotel occupancy

* occupancy rate

* maximum occupancy

maximum occupancy = 最大容納人數

> “Maximum occupancy: 50 persons.”

「最多可容納 50 人。」

This is an especially common safety/building use.

Related form: **occupant**

An **occupant** is a person who is currently in or using a room, building, vehicle, seat, etc.

Practice 28

> “All the vehicle’s **occupants** escaped safely.”

「車內所有**乘員**都安全逃生。」

Practice 29

> “The previous **occupant** left last month.”

「上一位**住戶 / 使用者**上個月搬走了。」

****occupant = 實際處於、居住或使用某個地方的人****

Contextual translations include:

* resident

* tenant

* passenger

* person inside

Related form: **occupier**

****Occupier** commonly means a person or organization that occupies premises or land.**

Practice 30

> “The **occupier** is responsible for maintaining the premises.”

「該處所的**佔用人** / 實際使用者**負責維護地方**。」

It can also refer to a force that occupies territory:

> occupying power / occupier

= **佔領者** / **佔領軍**

Occupier is especially common in legal/property British English.

Related form: **occupation**

Occupation has developed several major meanings of its own and deserves independent treatment if targeted.

The principal branches are:

occupation = job/profession (職業)

> “What is your occupation?”

「你的**職業**是甚麼？」

occupation = activity that occupies time (活動)

> “Reading was his favourite occupation.”

「閱讀是他最喜歡的**消遣 / 活動**。」

occupation = military control of territory (軍事佔領)

> “The occupation lasted several years.”

「這次**軍事佔領**持續了數年。」

occupation = possession/use of premises (土地 / 物業)

formal/legal:

> occupation of the property

= **實際佔用 / 使用物業**

Because **occupation** is independently highly polysemous, I would not pretend these are merely mechanical noun forms of **occupy**.

Related form: **occupational**

Occupational usually means relating to work, employment, or a person's occupation.

Practice 31

> “The company provides occupational safety training.”

「公司提供**職業安全**訓練。」

Common:

- * occupational health
- * occupational safety
- * occupational hazard
- * occupational therapy

This primarily derives from:

> occupation = job

rather than from physical **occupy space**.

Important distinction: **occupy vs use**

use

is broad and neutral.

occupy

often emphasizes that the space/resource is **taken up**, meaning others cannot use it simultaneously.

Compare:

> “They used the table.”

neutral.

> “They occupied the table for three hours.”

emphasizes prolonged possession of the table.

That nuance is crucial in your passage.

Important distinction: **occupy vs take up**

For physical space/time:

take up

is common and conversational.

occupy

is somewhat more formal.

> “The sofa takes up half the room.”

> “The sofa occupies half the room.”

Almost identical.

Important distinction: **occupy vs fill**

fill

means leave little/no empty space inside something.

occupy

means use or account for a particular space/position.

> books fill the shelf

> the desk occupies the corner

Different spatial relationship.

Important distinction: **occupy vs inhabit**

inhabit

specifically means live in a place.

occupy

can mean:

- * live in
- * use
- * sit in
- * control

- > animals inhabit the forest
- > company occupies the building

Occupy is much broader.

Important distinction: **occupy vs reside**

reside

means live somewhere, usually formally.

occupy

means physically possess/use the premises and does not necessarily imply it is your home.

- > reside at an address
- > occupy an office

Important distinction: **occupy vs possess**

possess

means have ownership/control.

occupy

means physically use or control a place.

You can occupy rented property without owning it.

Important distinction: **occupy vs invade**

invade

means enter a territory forcefully.

occupy

means remain there and exercise control.

An army may:

1. invade a country;
2. then occupy part of it.

They are not synonymous.

Important distinction: **occupy vs conquer**

conquer

means defeat and gain control through force.

occupy

focuses on the continuing physical presence/control afterwards.

A territory may be occupied without being formally annexed or permanently conquered.

Important distinction: **busy vs occupied**

busy

is the ordinary everyday adjective.

occupied

often means specifically engaged with an activity.

> “I’m busy.”

general.

> “I’m occupied with another task.”

more formal/specific.

Grammar note: **occupy is transitive**

Usually:

> occupy + object

Examples:

* occupy a seat

* occupy space

* occupy a building

* occupy a position

* occupy someone's thoughts

Not normally:

> “They occupied for three hours.” ❌

unless a special contextual object has already been omitted unusually.

Grammar note: **occupied by / occupied with**

Important contrast:

occupied by

often identifies who/what uses a place:

> “The room is occupied by students.”

「房間由學生使用。」

occupied with

often identifies an activity/thought:

> “She is occupied with work.”

「她正忙着工作。」

Countability note

Occupy is a verb.

Related nouns:

occupant

countable:

> an occupant

> several occupants

occupier

countable:

> an occupier

occupancy

usually uncountable as a state/rate concept:

> occupancy of the building

> hotel occupancy

occupation

countability depends strongly on its independent sense.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **occupy**
* **occupies**
* **occupied**
* **occupying**
* **occupancy**
* **occupant**
* **occupier**
* **occupation**
* **occupational**

A broad audit reveals four particularly important conceptual clusters:

1. **take/use physical space**
2. **fill time, attention, or thought**
3. **hold a position**
4. **take/control territory or premises**

Occupation then develops important independent senses such as **job**, which should be mapped separately rather than falsely counted as another meaning of bare **occupy**.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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occupy — physical space	使用、填滿或佔去某個位置 / 空間，使其他人難以同時使用
occupy — premises	實際居住、使用或控制房間、建築物、土地等
occupied — seat/room	目前已有有人使用 / 已被佔用的
occupy — position	擔任某職位，或在排名 / 結構中佔據某位置
occupy — time	佔用某人的時間 / 使某人保持忙碌
occupy someone's mind	持續佔據某人的思緒或注意力
occupied — busy	正忙於某項活動、沒有空閒的
occupy — military/protest	進駐並控制某個地區、城市、建築等；佔領 / 佔據
occupancy	使用 / 入住狀態；亦可指入住率、使用率
occupant	實際身處、居住或使用某場所的人
occupier	實際佔用土地 / 物業者；亦可指佔領者
occupation	職業；活動；佔領；物業佔用等，已形成獨立多義網絡
occupational	與工作 / 職業有關的

For your original sentence

> “...whether private educational activities should be allowed to **occupy commercial dining space for hours at a time**.”

The exact meaning is:

****occupy** = 長時間使用並佔着餐廳的桌子、座位和用餐空間，使這些空間無法正常供其他顧客使用******

So:

> ****occupy commercial dining space****

= ****佔用商業用餐空間****

The choice of ****occupy**** is stronger than simply:

> ****use the space****

because it foregrounds the fact that the space is ****taken up and unavailable to other diners****.

For your database, I would count ****5 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****occupy****:

1. ****take up/use physical space or premises****
2. ****hold a position, office, rank, or place****
3. ****fill someone's time / keep someone busy****
4. ****fill someone's thoughts or attention****
5. ****take possession/control of territory or a place, especially militarily or through organized occupation****

I would merge ****occupied seat/toilet/building**** into #1, keep ****occupy oneself with**** under #3, merge ranking uses with #2, and treat ****occupancy / occupant / occupier / occupation / occupational**** as family extensions rather than artificially increasing the base-verb count.